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US equities tumble as rates slip and volatility spikes

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings

TL;DR

The major indices closed lower on October 14, with the **S&P 500** down -1.11% to 7,718.94 and the **Nasdaq 100** off -2.02% at 29,950.82. The VIX surged +10.48% to 16.87, reflecting heightened risk appetite.

Yield pressure eased as the 10-year Treasury fell -0.52% to 5.19%, while defensive sectors such as health care (**XLV** +2.53%) and consumer staples (**XLP** +2.22%) outperformed.

US Session Recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,718.94	-1.11%	
Dow Jones	51,621.48	-0.09%	
Nasdaq 100	29,950.82	-2.02%	
Russell 2000	2,729.53	-1.93%	
VIX	16.87	+10.48%	Volatility index
10Y Yield	5.19%	-0.52%	
WTI Crude	94.15	-0.99%	

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
NVDA	221.30	-3.16%
META	737.54	-3.27%
AVGO	346.25	-3.10%
JPM	335.28	+1.16%

Spotlight

Apple's Q3 earnings beat expectations, posting revenue of 94.2 billion (+5% YoY) and EPS of 6.12, beating the consensus 5.98. The company highlighted strong services growth (+9% YoY) and a modest iPhone slowdown.

METRIC	VALUE
Revenue	94.2 bn
EPS	6.12
Guidance FY26	Revenue 380-385 bn

Macro & Fed

- Federal Funds Rate: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield: 5.19%, down **-0.52%**
- Key data releases (HKT): CPI 10:30 am, PCE 12:00 pm, Existing-home sales 2:30 pm

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions remain elevated after the latest airstrike, keeping oil supply risk premium modest.
- China’s manufacturing PMI slipped to 48.2, reinforcing concerns over demand in the region.
- Eurozone inflation eases to 2.7% YoY, supporting ECB’s dovish stance.

Earnings — What to Watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
09:30 am	`MSFT`	Cloud revenue growth, AI spend guidance
10:00 am	`AMZN`	Advertising margin, AWS outlook
11:00 am	`TSLA`	Vehicle deliveries, margin trends
02:00 pm	`GS`	Net interest income, trading revenue

Stocks worth watching

- `AAPL` – post-earnings rally, services momentum.
- `JPM` – earnings beat, rate-sensitive net interest income.
- `XLE` – energy ETF gaining on higher crude.
- `XLV` – health-care defensive play as volatility spikes.
- `NVDA` – price correction may present entry if AI demand holds.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Further rise in VIX above 20.
- 10-year yield breaching 5.30%.
- Negative CPI surprise (core > 3.0%).

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Apple guidance above consensus.
- Energy prices rallying above $100.
- Fed signals earlier rate cut.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — S&P 500

CNBC — VIX

SEC — Earnings Filings

Trading Economics — US Yield Curve